

Nielsen Norman Group

Heuristic Evaluation

Workbook

Use this workbook to conduct your own heuristic evaluation.

For each of Jakob's 10 Usability Heuristics, look for specific places where the interface fails to adhere to the guideline. Write your recommendations for how to fix those usability issues.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

1

Visibility of System Status

The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time.

- Does the design clearly communicate its state?
- Is feedback presented quickly after user actions?

Issues

1. The 'Sending...' state on the forgot-password screen dims the button but provides no progress indicator (spinner, progress bar, or estimated wait time). Users cannot tell if the action is processing or stuck.
2. The verification code screen shows a 4-digit code input but gives no indication of code expiry time, leaving users unsure how long they have.

Recommendations

1. Add a loading spinner inside the 'Send Verification Code' button while sending, and display a short text like 'Code sent! Check your inbox.' upon success.
2. Display a countdown timer (e.g. 'Code expires in 4:59') on the verification code screen, with a 'Resend code' link that becomes active after expiry.

2

Match Between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than internal jargon. Follow real-world conventions, making information appear in a natural and logical order.

- Will user be familiar with the terminology used in the design?
- Do the design's controls follow real-world conventions?

Issues

1. The Admin login asks for a 'Pharmacy name' — a domain-specific term unfamiliar to new admin users who may not yet know how their account is named in the system.
2. The role-selection screen labels are 'User' and 'Admin' — generic IT terminology that may not resonate with healthcare users (e.g. patients vs pharmacists).

Recommendations

1. Replace 'Pharmacy name' with 'Pharmacy / Organization' and add a placeholder like 'e.g. Metro Pharmacy'. Consider a helper link: 'What is my pharmacy name?'
2. Replace 'User' and 'Admin' with role labels meaningful to your users, e.g. 'Patient' and 'Pharmacist / Staff'. Add a brief one-line description under each.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

3

User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without having to go through an extended process.

- Does the design allow users to go back a step in the process?
- Are exit links easily discoverable?
- Can users easily cancel an action?
- Is Undo and Redo supported?

Issues

1. The Terms & Conditions modal has an X close button, but there is no 'Decline' action and no way to continue without agreeing. If a user scrolls past it accidentally, there's no way to re-open it before account creation.
2. The verification code screen has no 'Back' navigation visible on the Figma overlay components, trapping users who entered the wrong email.
3. The role-selection (User / Admin) screen has no back arrow to return to the splash screen.

Recommendations

1. Add clearly labeled 'Agree' and 'Decline' buttons to the T&C modal. Provide a persistent 'View Terms' link on the registration form so users can re-read before submitting.
2. Add a visible 'Back' link or arrow on the verification code screen that returns the user to the email entry step without losing their entered email.
3. Add a back arrow to the role-selection screen linking to the splash/Get Started screen.

4

Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. Follow platform and industry conventions.

- Does the design follow industry conventions?
- Are visual treatments used consistently throughout the design?

Issues

1. The 'Log In' button is blue on the User login, but the same action button appears in a different shade or style in the Admin and forgot-password flows.

Recommendations

1. Standardize the primary CTA button (color, size, corner radius) as a single reusable component. Apply it consistently to all login, register, and reset actions.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

5

Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully prevent problems from occurring in the first place. Either eliminate error-prone conditions, or check for them and present users with a confirmation option before they commit to the action.

- Does the design prevent slips by using helpful constraints?
- Does the design warn users before they perform risky actions?

Issues

1. Password fields on both the login and new-password screens have no show/hide toggle. Without it, users frequently mistype passwords and cannot self-correct, increasing error rates.
2. The 'Create new password' screen has two fields (New password, Confirm password) but no inline validation showing password strength or whether the two fields match as the user types.

Recommendations

1. Add a show/hide password toggle (eye icon) to all password fields.
2. Add real-time validation on the confirm-password field: show a green checkmark when both passwords match, and a red error if they don't. Add a password-strength meter.

6

Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another. Information required to use the design (e.g. field labels or menu items) should be visible or easily retrievable when needed.

- Does the design keep important information visible, so that users do not have to memorize it?
- Does the design offer help in-context?

Issues

1. The Admin login screen shows only blank input fields with placeholder text. Once the user starts typing, the label disappears, leaving users unsure what information is expected in each field.
2. The verification code screen offers an 'Auto fill' button but there is no explanation of what it does or where it reads the code from, which could confuse users on Android or older iOS versions.

Recommendations

1. Use floating labels (labels that animate above the field when focused) so the field's purpose is always visible, both before and after input.
2. Clarify the 'Auto fill' label to 'Auto fill from SMS' or simply remove it for devices that handle SMS OTP natively via the platform. Add a brief helper text: 'Enter the 4-digit code sent to your email.'

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

7

Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts — hidden from novice users — may speed up the interaction for the expert user such that the design can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users. Allow users to tailor frequent actions.

- Does the design provide accelerators like keyboard shortcuts and touch gestures?
- Is content and functionality personalized or customized for individual users?

Issues

1. There is no 'Remember me' or 'Stay signed in' option on any login screen, forcing frequent users to re-authenticate every session.

Recommendations

1. Add a 'Remember me for 30 days' checkbox to the login screen for both User and Admin, using secure token storage on device.

8

Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information that is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information in an interface competes with the relevant units of information and diminishes their relative visibility.

- Is the visual design and content focused on the essentials?
- Have all distracting, unnecessary elements been removed?

Issues

1. The Terms & Conditions modal presents 5 dense legal paragraphs in a small modal overlay with no scroll indicator. This violates minimalist design by overwhelming users at a critical decision point.
2. The 'Account created successfully!' screen uses a green checkmark and a single line of text but is a full-screen overlay. This is heavy for what could be a lighter toast notification or inline confirmation.

Recommendations

1. Trim the T&C modal to a short summary (3–4 bullet points) with a 'Read full terms' link to a dedicated page. Add a scroll progress indicator if you must display the full text in-modal.
2. Replace the full-screen success overlay with an inline success message or a brief toast notification ('Account created! Welcome to MedCare.') and auto-redirect to the login screen after 2 seconds.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

9

Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

- Does the design use traditional error message visuals, like bold, red text?
- Does the design offer a solution that solves the error immediately?

Issues

1. No error states are visible in the prototype for incorrect login credentials (wrong password, unregistered email). The design does not show what message appears or how it's styled.
2. The 'Password Reset Successful' confirmation screen is shown, which is good — but there's no indication of what the user should do next (e.g. 'Return to login' is small and easy to miss).

Recommendations

1. Design and document explicit error states: red inline error text below the affected field (e.g. 'Incorrect password. Try again or reset your password.') with a link to the forgot-password flow.
2. Make the 'Back to login' CTA on the password-reset success screen a full-width primary button, not a small text link, so the next step is unmistakably clear.

10

Help and Documentation

It's best if the system doesn't need any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users understand how to complete their tasks.

- Is help documentation easy to search?
- Is help provided in context right at the moment when the user requires it?

Issues

1. A 'Forgot password?' link is present on both the User and Admin login screens — correctly placed and contextually useful.
2. The registration screen includes a 'Sign in to Facebook' / 'Sign in with Google' option which provides an alternative path and implicitly helps users who forget which method they used.

Recommendations

1. Consider adding a short tooltip or info icon next to 'Pharmacy name' on the Admin screen explaining what this value represents and where to find it.
2. Add an FAQ-style help link ('Having trouble logging in?') at the bottom of each login screen that surfaces common issues without leaving the app.